Dr. Ramesh Kandel

Professor of Geriatric Medicine | Healthy Ageing & Geriatric Health Systems Expert

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Professor of Geriatric Medicine, nationally and internationally engaged healthy ageing expert with over a decade of experience in geriatric medicine, health systems strengthening, policy development, academic leadership, clinical governance, and WHO-supported healthy ageing initiatives in low- and middle-income settings. Recognized as one of the pioneering leaders in geriatric medicine in Nepal, with substantial expertise in Integrated Care for Older People (ICOPE), geriatric service development, curriculum design, research, and capacity building. Experienced in working with Ministry of Health & Food Safety: Government of Nepal, WHO Headquarters, WHO-SEARO, academic institutions, and multidisciplinary teams to develop and implement evidence-based healthy ageing strategies.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Healthy Ageing & ICOPE Implementation	Geriatric Health Systems Strengthening
Health Policy & Strategy Development	Medical Education & Curriculum Development
Clinical Governance & Hospital Administration	Research Leadership & Evidence Translation
Global Health & WHO Collaboration	Capacity Building & Workforce Training
Programme Management & Technical Consultancy	Academic Leadership & Institutional Development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Professor of Geriatric Medicine

Rapti Academy of Health Sciences (RAHS), Nepal | Nov 2025 – Present

- Leading geriatric academic, clinical, and research activities within a tertiary academic institution.
- Providing technical leadership on healthy ageing, frailty, and geriatric care models.

Dean, School of Medicine

Rapti Academy of Health Sciences | Oct 2024 – May 2026

- Led institutional academic governance and curriculum reform initiatives.
- Directed multidisciplinary academic and administrative coordination within the university.

Hospital Director

Rapti Academy of Health Sciences | Jul 2023 – Oct 2024

- Oversaw tertiary hospital operations, service delivery, and institutional quality improvement.
- Strengthened clinical governance and interdisciplinary coordination.

Medical Director

Rapti Academy of Health Sciences | Feb 2022 – Jul 2023

- Supervised medical services, strategic planning, and clinical operations.

- Contributed to institutional health system strengthening initiatives.

Associate Professor of Geriatric Medicine

Rapti Academy of Health Sciences | Feb 2022 – Nov 2025

- Established and expanded geriatric medicine services and academic activities.
- Led teaching, mentoring, and research activities in geriatric medicine.

Consultant & Chief of Geriatric Services

Hospital for Advanced Medicine and Surgery (HAMS), Nepal | Jan 2020 – Feb 2022

- Led geriatric clinical services and multidisciplinary care planning.
- Strengthened specialized geriatric care delivery in a tertiary hospital setting.

Consultant – Healthy Ageing

WHO South-East Asia Regional Office (WHO-SEARO), New Delhi | Jul 2019 – Dec 2019

- Supported regional healthy ageing and ICOPE-related initiatives.
- Contributed to development of training materials and technical consultation activities.

Clinical Faculty & Geriatrician

Patan Academy of Health Sciences | Sept 2015 – Jun 2019

- Delivered undergraduate and postgraduate medical education.
- Conducted clinical, academic, and research activities in geriatric medicine.

SELECTED CONSULTANCY & TECHNICAL ASSIGNMENTS

- WHO Clinical Consortium on Healthy Ageing (CCHA), Geneva, Switzerland (2024-2026) – Expert Member
- Program Coordinator and Consultant for WHO-supported project: 'Developing ICOPE Implementation Model in Lumbini Province, Nepal' (2024–2025).
- Principal Consultant for development of Nepal's National Geriatric Strategy 2077 under Ministry of Health and Population.
- Principal Consultant for development of Geriatric Service Standards 2078 for Government of Nepal.
- Consultant for development of WHO-supported ICOPE-based online learning system for primary health care workers.
- Principal Consultant for development of training materials for Geriatric Training of Medical Officers under National Health Training Centre (NHTC).
- Subject Expert and Reviewer for Minimum Service Standards (MSS), Ministry of Health and Population, Nepal.

EDUCATION

M.D. in Geriatric Medicine

All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), New Delhi, India | 2012–2015

MBBS

B.P. Koirala Institute of Health Sciences (BPKIHS), Dharan, Nepal | 2005–2011

Intermediate in Science (I.Sc.)

St. Xavier's Campus, Kathmandu, Nepal | 2002–2004

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Author and co-author of multiple peer-reviewed publications focusing on frailty, antimicrobial resistance, geriatric syndromes, healthy ageing, tuberculosis in older adults, geriatric oncology, and integrated care models for older people.

- Nepal's Geriatric Health Strategy 2021–2030: A Narrative Review (Journal of Indian Academy of Geriatrics, 2024).
- Caregiver Burden and Its Correlates among People with Alzheimer's Dementia: An Exploratory Study from Nepal (2021).
- Implementing and validating a care protocol for older adults with cancer in resource-limited settings (Journal of Geriatric Oncology, 2021).
- Nordic walking training and nutritional supplementation in pre-frail older Indians (BMC Geriatrics, 2018).

Full publication list available in annexure.

SELECTED INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

- WHO Clinical Consortium on Healthy Ageing (CCHA), Geneva, Switzerland – Expert participant and presenter.
- WHO Global Network on Long-Term Care (GNLTC), Geneva, Switzerland – Expert participant.
- International Federation on Ageing Global Conference – Presented Nepal's experience in ICOPE implementation.
- Alzheimer's Association International Conference (AAIC), Chicago, USA – Travel grant recipient.
- World Congress of International Association of Gerontology and Geriatrics (IAGG), San Francisco, USA – Travel grant recipient.
- European Union Geriatric Medicine Society Conference, Rotterdam, Netherlands – Oral presentation.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Founder President – National Institute on Ageing & Health (NIAH), Nepal
- Member – Geriatric Society of Nepal
- International Advisor – Journal of Indian Academy of Geriatrics
- Lifetime Member – Nepal Medical Association
- Lifetime Associate Member – Society of Internal Medicine of Nepal (SIMON)
- Member – Geriatric Expert Committee, National Human Rights Commission, Nepal
- Lifetime Member – Alzheimer and Related Dementia Society Nepal (ARDS-N)
- Lifetime Member – Indian Academy of Geriatrics and Gerontology (IAGG)

LANGUAGES

English | Nepali | Hindi

ANNEXURE: FULL PUBLICATION LIST

- Association Between Frailty Status and Antimicrobial Resistance Patterns in Uropathogens Isolated from Older People: A Cross-Sectional Study at a Tertiary Care Hospital in Nepal (2025).
- Antimicrobial Resistance among Older Patients attending Rapti Academy of Health Sciences: A Retrospective Study (2025).
- Geriatric Syndromes in Older People Attending Geriatric Outpatient Department in a Tertiary Care Center in Western Nepal (2025).
- Nepal's Geriatric Health Strategy 2021–2030: A Narrative Review (2024).
- Challenges and determinants in the management of older patients with cancer (2021).
- Caregiver Burden and Its Correlates among People with Alzheimer's Dementia: An Exploratory Study from Nepal (2021).
- Lung cancer in the older population: ACE gene polymorphism and tobacco addiction in risk assessment (2021).
- Old age-associated enrichment of peripheral T regulatory cells and altered redox status in pulmonary tuberculosis (2020).
- Implementing and validating a care protocol for older adults with cancer in resource-limited settings (2021).
- Nordic walking training and nutritional supplementation in pre-frail older Indians (2018).
- Reversible ototoxicity: A rare adverse reaction of Liposomal Amphotericin-B (2014).
- Multiple atypical presentations in a case of multiple myeloma in an elderly female (2014).
- An unexpected cause of orbital apex syndrome in an immune-competent elderly male (2014).
- Unusual presentation of tuberculosis in an elderly male: A case report (2015).

Original Research Articles

1. Kandel R, et al. Association Between Frailty Status and Antimicrobial Resistance Patterns in Uropathogens Isolated from Older People: A Cross-Sectional Study at a Tertiary Care Hospital in Nepal. Journal of Indian Academy of Geriatrics. 2025.
2. Kandel R, et al. Antimicrobial Resistance among Older Patients attending Rapti Academy of Health Sciences: A Retrospective Study. Journal of Rapti Academy of Health Sciences. 2025.
3. Kandel R, et al. Geriatric Syndromes in Older People Attending Geriatric Outpatient Department in a Tertiary Care Center in Western Nepal. Journal of Rapti Academy of Health Sciences. 2025.
4. Kandel R, et al. Challenges and determinants in the management of the older patients with cancer. Journal of Indian Academy of Geriatrics. 2021.
5. Kandel R, et al. Caregiver Burden and Its Correlates among People with Alzheimer's Dementia: An Exploratory Study from Nepal. Journal of Indian Academy of Geriatrics. 2021.
6. Kandel R, et al. Lung cancer in the older population: Interactive effects of ACE gene polymorphism and tobacco addiction in risk assessment. Indian Journal of Cancer. 2021.
7. Kandel R, et al. Old age-associated enrichment of peripheral T regulatory cells and altered redox status in pulmonary tuberculosis. European Journal of Immunology. 2020.
8. Kandel R, et al. Implementing and validating a care protocol for older adults with cancer in resource-limited settings with a newly developed screening tool. Journal of Geriatric Oncology. 2021.
9. Kandel R, et al. Nordic walking training and nutritional supplementation in pre-frail older Indians: An open-labelled pilot study. BMC Geriatrics. 2018.

Review Articles

10. Kandel R, et al. Nepal's Geriatric Health Strategy 2021–2030: A Narrative Review. Journal of Indian Academy of Geriatrics. 2024.

Case Reports

11. Kandel R, et al. Reversible ototoxicity: A rare adverse reaction of Liposomal Amphotericin-B used for treatment of antimony-resistant visceral Leishmaniasis in an elderly male. Clinical Medicine Insights: Case Reports. 2014.
12. Kandel R, et al. Multiple atypical presentations in a case of multiple myeloma in an elderly female. European Geriatric Medicine. 2014.

13. Kandel R, et al. An unexpected cause of orbital apex syndrome in an immune-competent elderly male. Oxford Medical Case Reports. 2014.
14. Kandel R, et al. Unusual presentation of tuberculosis in an elderly male: A case report. Clinical Case Reports. 2015.